Known for his humility, affection, and concern for fellowmen, in the last decade of his life Parekh gave most of his time and energy to philanthropic causes. In 1986, he was one of the founders of the Centre for Advancement of Philanthropy, which was founded to help trusts and NGO's with problems concerning tax laws, dealing with the charity commissioner's office, and to enable new trusts to be formed. He served as its Chairman since its inception until his retirement in 1993. The man who succeeded him was R.M. Lala, who Parekh had been persuading to accept the Chairmanship as he wanted to step down. Lala kept refusing but one day Parekh told the Board he was stepping down and proposed Lala's name.

His concern and love for the city of Bombay, led him to form the Bombay Community Public Trust in 1991. This venture, inspired by a similar organization in New York, was designed specifically to address the needs of disadvantaged citizens in the city of Mumbai. He took the initiative to finance Mumbai's first public toilet by any corporate house—Sulabh Shauchalaya. Additionally, Parekh served as a trustee of many trusts including the Sameeksha Trust, where along with Sachin Chaudhuri and P.B. Gajendragadkar, he was one of the trio who signed the deed for setting up the Trust. The Trust and the *Economic and Political Weekly* owed much to Parekh's sagacity in the three decades after the death of its founder-editor Sachin Chaudhuri.

Parekh was also the Chairman of the IMC's Economic Research and Training Foundation for nearly sixteen years. Its primary objective was to disseminate information and knowledge about nationally important social and economic problems in simple, non-technical language which a common man could understand. Parekh also served as the President of the Social Service League, a charitable institution which undertook activities in several areas such as adult education, medical relief, technical education, cultural activity, industrial schools for women, night schools, children's education classes and mobile libraries, among others.

Parekh believed in service without publicity, and without a thought of personal gain. He believed that while public participation in cash and kind did play a significant role in the process of social betterment, it was far from adequate, and a lot more had to be done by increasing public awareness and creation of suitable agencies. In short, Parekh believed in sharing and caring. In 1992, Parekh was honoured with the Padma